Uses

Glazed ceramic

The bowl's smooth finish *is due to strontium oxide.*

Navigation buoy

Lights in unmanned buoys *can be powered by radioactive strontium.*

Loudspeaker

Magnets inside this loudspeaker *contain strontium.*

Strontium burns *in air with a bright red colour.*

Flare

Strontium compounds in some toothpastes *provide relief from pain.*

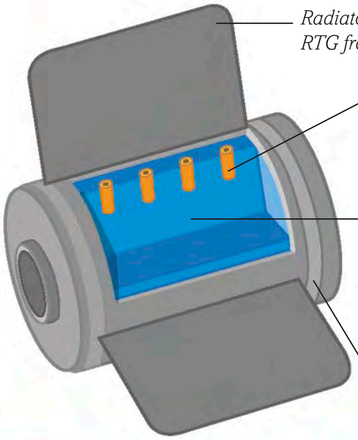
Toothpaste for sensitive teeth

Unmanned radar stations *run on electricity produced using a form of strontium called strontium-90.*

Weather radar station

GENERATING ELECTRICITY

A radioactive form of strontium, called an isotope, can be used to produce electricity. A radioisotopic thermoelectrical generator (RTG) converts heat from the element into electricity for use in spacecraft.



Radiator fin prevents the RTG from overheating.

A thermocouple is a device that converts heat from the radioactive metal into electricity.

Inside the capsule, atoms of radioactive strontium break down into those of lighter elements and produce heat.

RTG is insulated to stop radioactivity from leaking out.

there are fewer uses for it. Strontium oxide in pottery and **ceramic** glazes creates distinctive colours, while strontium carbonate produces a red colour in **flares** and fireworks. Magnets that contain iron oxide can be made stronger by adding strontium to them. These strong magnets are used in **loudspeakers** and microwave ovens. Strontium chloride is added to some kinds of **toothpaste**, while radioactive strontium is a source of electricity for **radar stations** in remote places where there are no power lines or fuel supplies.